- Host AP driver for Prism2/2.5/3 [linux]
- Driver interface for FreeBSD net80211 layer [kfreebsd]
- Any wired Ethernet driver for wired IEEE 802.1X authentication

Now let's check whether your Wi-Fi card is supported by Hostapd. Most commonly used Wi-Fi cards are supported in Hostapd, but just to be sure, we could check.
First, check which kernel driver is used for your card, then type the following command:

```
lspci -k | grep -A 3 -i "network"

Network controller: Ralink corp. RT3290 Wireless 802.11n
1T/1R PCIe
      Subsystem: Hewlett-Packard Company Device 18ec
      Kernel driver in use: rt2800pci
      Kernel modules: rt2800pci
```

The driver used by the kernel is *rt2800pci*. This will vary depending on your kernel and your Wi-Fi card. Now, let's check the interface part, which will tell us whether our card is supported or not. Next, type the following command:

```
modinfo rt2800pci | grep 'depends'
```

…replacing *driver* with your appropriate one, which in my case is *rt2800pci*.

This will vary depending on your Wi-Fi card. In my case, it is:

```
rt2x00lib,rt2800lib,rt2x00pci,compat,eeprom_93cx6
```

Check each interface with the compatibility list either by checking if your interface satisfies one of the conditions required by Hostapd or by 'googling' with the keyword 'interface_name hostapd'. You might get some clue if one or more interfaces match with the list needed by Hostapd—then you are good to go. Otherwise, cross your fingers and give it a try by configuring it as explained below.

Configuration

Now, let's create a configuration file named *test.conf* with your favourite text editor in your home directory. Lines starting with # are just comments to explain the configuration; you can skip them while writing the configuration file:

```
# sets the wifi interface to use, is wlan0 in most case
interface=wlan0
# driver to use, nl80211 works in most cases
driver=nl80211
# Choose suitable name for SSID, or simply the name of your
wifi as visible on list of networks
ssid=Put_your_desried_name_here
# sets the mode of wifi, depends upon the device used, can be
a,b,g,n.  g ensures backward #compatibility.
hw_mode=g
# sets the channel for your wifi , 11 will work fine for most
of the people
channel=11
#####Sets WPA and WPA2 authentication , they are stronger
than WEP#####
#wpa option sets which wpa implementation to use
#1 - wpa only
#2 - wpa2 only
#3 - both
wpa=3
# sets password for the access point, choose a strong one :)
wpa_passphrase=Put_here_your_desired_password
# sets wpa key management
wpa_key_mgmt=WPA-PSK
#sets encryption used
wpa_pairwise=TKIP CCMP
# Rekeys after 10 minutes,if there is interference, the wifi
```

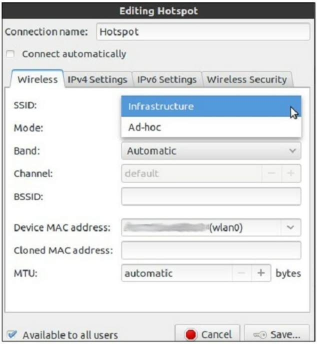

Figure 1: Types of wireless networks

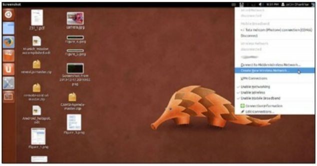
Figure 2: Creating a New Wireless Connection